

FREE RESOURCE · ELEVATION AXIS

Google Listing Quick-Fix Guide

Your Google listing is the first thing a customer sees.
This guide shows you exactly what to fill in,
what to fix, and what to never leave blank.

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Your Google listing works while you sleep.

When someone searches for your service in your city, Google shows them a map with three businesses before it shows any websites. That map pack gets more clicks than everything below it combined.

If your Google Business Profile is incomplete, incorrect, or missing — you don't show up. And if you don't show up, that customer calls someone else. This guide walks you through every section of your profile and tells you exactly what to do.

BEFORE YOU START

Go to business.google.com and sign in. If you haven't claimed your listing yet, search your business name first — Google may have already created one for you. Claim it before you fill anything in.

Section by Section

01

Business Name

Use your exact legal business name. No keywords stuffed in. No location added. Google penalizes listings that do this. Just your name — exactly as it appears everywhere else.

NEVER DO THIS: 'Smith's HVAC Indianapolis Best Air Conditioning'

02

Category

This is the most important field on your profile. Choose the most specific primary category that describes what you do. Then add secondary categories for every other service you offer. Most businesses leave secondary categories empty — that's lost visibility.

Example: Primary: 'HVAC Contractor' / Secondary: 'Air Conditioning Repair Service,' 'Furnace Repair Service,' 'Air Duct Cleaning Service'

03

Phone Number

Use a local phone number, not an 800 number. Make sure it matches exactly what's on your website and Facebook page. Inconsistent numbers hurt your local ranking.

Check: Does tapping this number on a phone open your dialer immediately?

04

Address & Service Area

If you go to customers (HVAC, plumbing, contractors, etc.), hide your address and set a service area instead. List every city and zip code you actually serve. The bigger your accurate service area, the more searches you appear in.

If you have a physical location customers visit — show the address. Both can be true.

05

Hours

Set accurate hours for every day you're open, including holidays. If you offer emergency or after-hours service, add that in the description. A listing showing 'Closed' when you're actually open is losing you calls right now.

Set holiday hours in advance. Google will prompt you — don't ignore it.

Section by Section

06

Website

Link to your actual website homepage, not a Facebook page or booking link. If you don't have a website, this is your biggest leak.

Check: Does clicking the link go to a site that loads fast on mobile?

07

Description

Write 2-3 sentences about what you do, who you serve, and what makes you different. Include your city and service naturally — don't keyword stuff. End with a clear call to action.

Example: 'Smith's HVAC has served Indianapolis homeowners since 2015. We specialize in same-day repairs and honest pricing. Call us for a free estimate.'

08

Photos

Add at least 10 photos — your team, your work, your truck, your space. Listings with photos get dramatically more clicks than those without. Add new photos every month. Google rewards active listings.

Cover photo: your storefront or team. Logo: your actual logo, clean background.

Reviews change everything.

A complete profile with no reviews is still a weak profile. Reviews are the single biggest factor in whether a customer chooses you over a competitor with the same services.

1 Get your review link

In Google Business Profile, go to 'Ask for reviews.' Copy the direct link. This is what you'll send customers.

2 Ask within 24 hours of a job

The best time to ask is right after you finish — while the experience is fresh. Text is better than email. Personal is better than automated.

3 Send this exact message

'Hey [Name], it was great working with you today. If you have 60 seconds, a Google review would mean a lot to us — here's the link: [link]. Thanks so much.'

4 Respond to every review

Good and bad. Google rewards businesses that engage. A response to a bad review shows future customers how you handle problems.

Want someone to do this for you?

I set up and optimize Google profiles as part of every engagement. Get a free audit and I'll show you exactly what your listing is missing right now.

Get Your Free Audit →
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